Unit Studio

Five steps for every unit you plan. Ask the questions yourself, or give each step to an AI tool with the prompt overleaf. Then let the AI write the improved plan, and review it before you teach it.

STEP 1 Goal and evidence Framework

- What should students be able to do by the end of the unit?
- Where will you see that they can do it?
- Does every activity lead towards that evidence?

STEP 2 Prior knowledge Framework

- What must students already know for this unit to work?
- Which of it is likely to be missing or mixed up?
- How will you check it before you build on it?

STEP 3 Sequence and load Strong

- How much new does each lesson bring?
- Are new ideas modelled with worked examples before students practise alone?
- Where does support fade as students get more confident?

STEP 4 Retrieval and checkpoints Strong

- Where does earlier content come back later in the unit?
- Where will you check the whole class before moving on?
- What will you do if fewer than about 4 in 5 get it?

STEP 5 Motivation and AI decisions Promising Choosewise

- What gives students a reason to care, and a sense that they can succeed?
- Where do students talk and think together?
- Where could AI help or harm their learning, and what would they get worse at if AI did that part?

WITHOUT THE WEBSITE

Your step prompt

Fill in the blanks and type the prompt into any AI tool. For a new unit, write "The teacher is planning a new unit. Topic and goals:" instead of the unit line.

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Do not include student names or student results in this conversation.

You are helping a Grade _____ _____ teacher improve a unit of _____ weeks with
_____ lessons a week. We work through five steps, one at a time. This is step _____ of 5:
_____.

The unit as the teacher has planned it:
_____
_____

Decisions so far:
_____

(the step's description from the website, or your own words for it)

Reply in plain text, no tables, in exactly this format:
KEEP: what already works for this step, in one or two lines. For a new unit, what in the topic and
goals is already clear.
SUGGEST: at most three changes for this step, numbered, each tied to this unit's content, each
with one line on why it helps students learn.
QUESTION: one question back to the teacher before the next step.
AI CAN ALSO: one other way an AI tool could help with this step, written as a short prompt the
teacher can copy.
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The final step: ask for the improved plan in this format

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Reply in plain text, no tables, in exactly this format:
GOAL AND EVIDENCE: what students should be able to do by the end, and how the teacher will see it
PRIOR KNOWLEDGE: what students need first, and how to check it in the first lesson
LESSONS: one line per lesson, numbered, with what students do and roughly how long
RETRIEVAL: which earlier content returns in which lessons
CHECKPOINTS: where in the unit to check understanding, how, and what to do if fewer than about 4
in 5 get it
AI USE: where students use AI in this unit, where they do not, and why
CHANGES: what is different from the original plan, one line each, or "New unit"
CHECK: anything the teacher should verify before teaching, one per line, or "None"
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